

DOES THIS SECTION EVEN NEED AN INTRODUCTION? FROM COMPUTERS TO MOBILES, AND HEADPHONES TO GPUs, IT'S ALL HERE...

THIS MONTH IN TECH: VSCO and TikTok pro tips, find out what's inside the Atari 2600, get started with Dart, explore the origins of CNC machines, and find out what it takes to design keyboards for Indic languages



No more desert names for Android

In a bid to have more accessibility with the Android ecosystem, Google announced that it is moving away from desert themed names and shifting to a more simpler numerical system. Android Q will now be known as Android 10. <https://dgit.in/Qisnow10>

WHAT'S NEW

SMART Act to curtail addictive social media mechanisms

The Social Media Addiction Reduction Technology Act, introduced in the US Senate, could spell the end of addictive mechanisms used by websites to retain users. The act proposes measures to prevent social media platforms from utilising tactics such as infinite scrolling, music and video autoplay mechanisms, and gamification methods. It would also make it mandatory for social media platforms to make their users aware about the amount of time they're spending on the platforms. While all the



methods combined do have a pronounced effect on the user, it's not necessary causing addition. Psy-

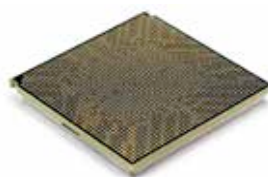
chology experts classify addiction as behaviours that negatively impacts the user. This varies vastly from user-to-user and having a blanket ban on the individual methods might not be the right way of reducing addition.

<https://dgit.in/SMARTAct>

IBM open-sources Power Instruction Set Architecture

IBM, the maker of the Power Series processors, has announced that it is moving the OpenPower Foundation under The Linux Foundation. With this move, IBM is also open-sourcing few additional elements from the Power Series IP. The Power Instruction Set Architecture (ISA) is one of the key elements that are being open-sourced along with this move. In an interview with TechCrunch, Ken

King, GM OpenPower at IBM said, "The first thing is that we are taking the ability to be



able to implement what we're licensing, the ISA instruction set architecture, for others to be able to implement on top

of that instruction set royalty free with patent right." IBM is also open-sourcing the softcore implementation of the Power ISA, reference designs for Open Coherent Accelerator Processor Interface (Open-CAPI) and the Open Memory Interface (OMI). This move will allow developers to come up with their own instruction sets and add onto them without having to pay any royalties.

<https://dgit.in/PISAOS>



Intel announces 10th Gen mobile CPUs

Intel unveiled 10nm and 14nm based U and Y-series processors from the Ice Lake (10nm) and Comet Lake (14nm) families. The Ice Lake processors will sport newer IGP but feature lower core counts whereas Comet Lake processors go vice-versa.

<https://dgit.in/10thIntel>



Webkit announces new tracking prevention policy

WebKit, the web engine that powers Apple's Safari browser has announced a new tracking prevention policy inspired by Mozilla's recent attempts in the same domain. It will prevent all covert and cross-site tracking.

<https://dgit.in/WebKitNT>



Verizon to sell Tumblr to Automattic Inc.

Tumblr, the social network, which was acquired by Yahoo! in 2013 for \$1.1 billion is being sold to Automattic Inc. for an undisclosed price that's allegedly between \$10-20 million. Automattic will get the network and retain about 200 employees.

<https://dgit.in/tumblr10m>